Diego Fernández Meijide

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Research interests: Applied microeconomics; economics of education; economics of AI; labor economics; crime, behavioral economics, and political economy.

Education

Master in Economics — thesis in progress Coursework: 2024
Universidad de San Andrés Argentina
Coursework average: 8.28/10.

Master in Public Policy Mar. 2022 – Dec. 2023
Universidad Torcuato Di Tella Argentina
GPA: 9.5/10. Class rank: 2/47.

Thesis: *The Art of (Automatically) Grading: Using Language Models to Evaluate Texts.* Original title: *El arte de corregir (automáticamente): el uso de modelos de lenguaje para la evaluación de textos.* Advisor: María Lombardi (Academic Dean, School of Government, UTDT).

Bachelor in Economics Mar. 2015 – Jul. 2021
Universidad de Buenos Aires Argentina
GPA: 7.47/10. *Cum laude.*

Publications & Working Papers

Cruces, Guillermo, **Diego Fernández Meijide**, Sebastian Galiani, Ramiro H. Gálvez, and María Lombardi. 2026. "Does Generative AI Narrow Education-Based Productivity Gaps? Evidence from a Randomized Experiment." *NBER Working Paper* No. 34851. doi:10.3386/w34851.

Buccari, Florencia, and **Diego Fernández**. 2025. "EdTech e IA en educación: potencial transformador y desafíos." In *Digitalización e IA: avances y desafíos sectoriales en América Latina y el Caribe*, pp. 77–119. CAF. [Chapter].

Migdalek, Maia Julieta, Celia Renata Rosemberg, Martha Shiro, and **Diego Fernández Meijide**. 2023. "Disputas entre niños de distintos grupos sociales: complejidad argumentativa, evaluación y evidencialidad." *ALPHA. Revista de Artes, Letras y Filosofía*, 2(57): 235–251. doi:10.32735/S0718-22012023000573287.

Research & Consulting Experience

Research Consultant Apr. 2025 – Present
CAF — Development Bank of Latin America and the Caribbean
- Coauthored a chapter on EdTech and AI in education; analyzed data and evidence on digitalization and educational outcomes in Latin America and the Caribbean.
- Developing a policy report on the differential impact of organized crime on women in Latin America and the Caribbean.
- Working on a paper on in-group gender bias in judicial decisions in São Paulo, Brazil.
- Working on research on municipal mayoral turnover, bureaucratic structure, and budget allocation in Mexican municipalities.

Research Assistant Sep. 2024 – Mar. 2026
Guillermo Cruces, Sebastian Galiani, Ramiro H. Gálvez, and María Lombardi
- Analyzed experimental data, coordinated survey teams, contributed to survey development, and developed automated grading tools using the OpenAI API for a randomized experiment on generative AI and education-based productivity gaps.

Impact Evaluation Consultant 2025
Dirección Nacional de Contrataciones Públicas, Paraguay
- Collaborated with Guillermo Cruces on an IDB-funded impact evaluation of a system for detecting fraud in public procurement.

Research Assistant — Childhood Language and Learning 2020; 2021
PIP 702/21; SECYT–FONCYT PICT 02896/2019
- Provided statistical analysis on vocabulary, discourse, and learning opportunities in early childhood and home contexts (unpaid research appointments).

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant — Econometric Methods and Applied Industrial Organization 2025
Master in Economics, Universidad de San Andrés

Teaching Assistant — Microeconomics 2025
Master in Public Policy, Universidad Torcuato Di Tella

Teaching Assistant — Economics 1 2024
Undergraduate course, Universidad de San Andrés

Policy Evaluation & Professional Experience

Evaluation Analyst Dec. 2022 – Jan. 2024
Buenos Aires City Government — Chief of Staff's Office
- Led and supported descriptive and causal evaluations of public policies and social programs, including *Codo a Codo* and *Aprendé Programando*.
- Applied econometric methods in Stata and R to assess labor-market outcomes; cleaned, analyzed, and visualized survey microdata using R and QGIS.
- Supported impact evaluation design in collaboration with multidisciplinary teams.

Evaluation Intern Jun. 2022 – Dec. 2022
AYINI — Local Innovators Program Evaluation Team
- Conducted statistical analysis and processed outcome data from local innovation projects for policy research.

Analyst Feb. 2021 – Mar. 2022
Buenos Aires City Government — Ministry of Education
- Managed children's orchestra programs and designed, implemented, and analyzed enrollment surveys.

Public Writing

Fernández Meijide, Diego. 2026. "Las Islas Malvinas y una IA obsecuente." *Clarín* (op-ed).

Selected Graduate Coursework

Economics (UdeSA): Applied Economics (10/10); Econometric Methods and Applied Industrial Organization (10/10); Spatial Econometrics (9/10); Natural Language Processing (9/10); Big Data (9/10).

Public Policy (UTDT): Impact Evaluation of Public Policies I (9/10) and II (10/10).

Skills & Languages

Programming: R, Stata, Python (advanced); QGIS, GeoDa (intermediate).

Methods: Causal inference, econometrics, machine learning.

Research tools: Generative AI APIs (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google); LaTeX, R Markdown.

Languages: Spanish (native); English (C2); German (C1).

Academic web development: Designed and built Guillermo Cruces's academic website.

Standardized Tests

TOEFL iBT: 5.5/6 (110/120), May 2026.

Cambridge Certificate of Proficiency in English (CPE): 214, Grade B (CEFR C2), December 2021.

Deutsches Sprachdiplom II (DSD II): CEFR C1.

GRE General Test: Quantitative Reasoning 165/170; Verbal Reasoning 162/170, October 2026.